What is a consumer?

BACKGROUND

mammals (say 'ma-mels') – warm-blooded animals with backbones that feed their young with milk

producers (say 'pro-dews-ers') – living things that make their own food from non-living ingredients

Consumers are types of organisms that eat or use food products made by producers or that eat other consumers. Large land mammals, birds and reptiles are consumers.

There are three main types of consumers:

- **herbivores** (consumers that eat plants)
- **carnivores** (consumers that eat animals, or meat)
- **omnivores** (consumers that eat both plants and animals).

Humans are omnivores. We eat all sorts of foods produced by plants, and we also eat other animals that eat plants and animals.

☞ **1** List six types of living things that are consumers.

_____ _____

_____ _____

_____ _____

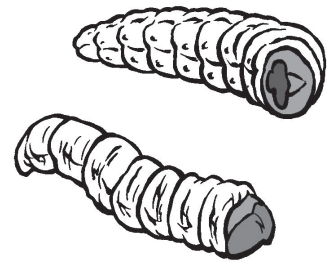
2 Decide whether these things are producers or consumers. Circle your response for each one.



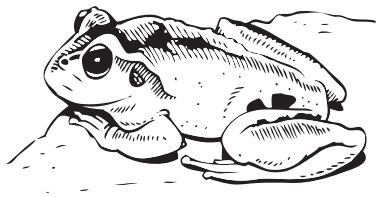
a producer OR consumer



b producer OR consumer



c producer OR consumer



d producer OR consumer



e producer OR consumer

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What is a consumer? CONT'D

Most carnivores are **predators**. Predators hunt, kill and eat other living things. The living thing that a predator hunts is called its **prey**. For example, the African lion is a fierce predator that needs meat to survive. Its prey includes wildebeest, zebras and giraffes.

3 **a)** Which of the living things in the box are predators? Underline your choices.

b) Which of the living things in the box are prey for different types of predators? Circle your choices.

tiger	caterpillar	snail	zebra
brown bear	mouse	rabbit	dingo

c) Look at the living things you have underlined. List each one below and write whether that predator is a carnivore or omnivore.

Predator: _____ Carnivore or omnivore? _____

Predator: _____ Carnivore or omnivore? _____

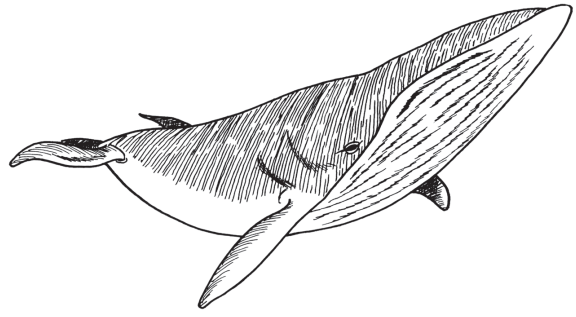
Predator: _____ Carnivore or omnivore? _____

4 **a)** Which of these animals have no natural predators to fear in their ecosystems? Circle your choices.

blue whale	lizard	prawn
rabbit	crocodile	lion

b) Look at the animals you have circled. What animal hunts and kills these animals, but is not considered a natural predator?

_____



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